



CURRENT AFFAIRS

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National

1. Varanasi, the parliamentary constituency of Prime Minister Narendra Modi, has entered the Guinness World Records by planting over 2.5 lakh saplings within a single hour. The large-scale environmental initiative was undertaken by the Varanasi Municipal Corporation on 1st March, drawing participation from more than 20,000 residents.

2. Climate change could drastically shrink the habitat of the Nilgiri Wood Pigeon by the end of the century, according to a recent scientific study. The species, endemic to the Western Ghats, may face sharp declines in high-suitability habitats as global temperatures rise.

3. Researchers have reported the discovery of fragments of a 12th-century Mandir-style stone pillar near the banks of the Vena River in Hinganghat town of Maharashtra's Wardha district, around 70 km from Nagpur. The find is being viewed as fresh evidence of the town's historical and cultural importance during the medieval period.

4. Union Minister of State for Education and Development of North Eastern Region, Dr. Sukanta Majumdar, presided over a football distribution programme at PM SHRI Kendriya Vidyalaya in Dakshin Dinajpur, West Bengal, under the Football for Schools (F4S) initiative. The programme is being implemented by the Ministry of Education in collaboration with the AIFF and FIFA.

5. In a landmark development for Jammu and Kashmir's prison administration, Saba Shawl has been appointed as Superintendent of Central Jail Srinagar, becoming the first Kashmiri woman to head the high-security correctional facility. The transfer was formalised under Government Order No. 145-Home of 2026 dated 2nd March 2026, with immediate effect.

6. Tamil Nadu has reaffirmed its position as India's leading state in deceased organ donation, recording 57 deceased donors in the first two months of 2026 - nearly one donation a day. The programme is overseen by the Transplant Authority of Tamil

Nadu (Transtan), which has built a structured and transparent system over nearly two decades.

7. The Bureau of Energy Efficiency (BEE), under the Ministry of Power, celebrated its 25th Foundation Day at the India Habitat Centre, New Delhi, with senior policymakers, State representatives and sectoral stakeholders in attendance. Shri Manohar Lal, Cabinet Minister for Power and Housing & Urban Affairs, graced the occasion as Chief Guest, while Shri Pankaj Agarwal, Secretary (Power), delivered the keynote address.

8. K. P. Unnikrishnan, former Union Minister and six-time Member of Parliament from Vadakara, died in Kozhikode, Kerala, in the early hours of Tuesday, 3rd March 2026. He was 89. He was undergoing treatment for age-related ailments at a private hospital.

9. Andhra Pradesh Deputy Chief Minister Pawan Kalyan launched "Project HANUMAN" on 3rd March 2026, coinciding with World Wildlife Day. The initiative aims to address the rising incidents of human-wildlife conflict in the state while strengthening wildlife rescue, treatment and monitoring systems.

10. Finland's President Alexander Stubb will undertake an official visit to India from 4th to 7th March 2026, at the invitation of Prime Minister Narendra Modi. He will serve as the Chief Guest at the 11th Raisina Dialogue in New Delhi, India's premier conference on geopolitics and strategic affairs.

11. Veteran journalist and Padma Bhushan awardee Harkishan Singh (HK) Dua passed away in New Delhi on 4th March 2026, at the age of 88. According to his family, he had been undergoing treatment at a private hospital for nearly three weeks after falling ill. His cremation is scheduled to take place on 5th March at the Lodhi Road Crematorium in New Delhi.

12. The historic Hatti Risala procession in Jalna, Maharashtra, completed its 138th year with vibrant celebrations during Dhulivandan, the day

following the Holi festival. The annual event drew large crowds as residents gathered along the city's main streets to witness the traditional procession.

13. Kenya's Prime Cabinet Secretary Musalia Mudavadi will visit New Delhi from 5th to 7th March to participate in the 11th Raisina Dialogue, India's premier conference on geopolitics and geoeconomics. His visit underscores Nairobi's push to deepen diplomatic and economic ties with India while positioning Kenya as a strategic gateway to Africa.

14. A 16th-century bronze statue of Saint Tirumankai Alvar, originally from a temple in Tamil Nadu, is set to be returned to India by the Ashmolean Museum at the University of Oxford. The statue, measuring 57.5 centimetres in height, had been part of the museum's collection since 1967.

15. President Droupadi Murmu will inaugurate the Darjeeling Hill Festival at the Durbar Hall of Raj Bhavan in Darjeeling, recently renamed Lok Bhavan. The festival is designed as a large cultural platform celebrating India's diverse tribal traditions and heritage.

16. The Debrigarh Wildlife Sanctuary will host the second edition of the two-day 'Indian Bison Fest' on 8th March at Zeropoint, highlighting conservation of the Indian bison, locally known as 'Gayala'. Organised by the Hiraakud Wildlife Division, the festival aims to bring together students, researchers, volunteers and nature enthusiasts to celebrate the growing gaur population in the Debrigarh-Hiraakud landscape.

17. Tamil Nadu has inaugurated its first Dark Sky Park at the Ariyur Shola Reserve Forest in Kolli Hills, Namakkal district, marking a significant step towards promoting astro-tourism in the State. The facility was launched by Forest Minister R. S. Rajakannappan from Chennai.

18. Union Minister for Chemicals and Fertilisers J. P. Nadda highlighted the government's strategic push towards strengthening India's bio-pharmaceutical and chemical sectors through major budgetary provisions. Addressing a post-Budget webinar on "Sustaining and Strengthening

Economic Growth", he emphasised that the Rs. 13,000 crore allocation for Bio-Pharma SHAKTI and the establishment of three dedicated chemical parks reflects a long-term investment in India's industrial and healthcare future..

19. A major leak of hazardous oleum gas at a chemical manufacturing unit in Maharashtra's Palghar district triggered panic and prompted authorities to evacuate more than 2,600 people as a precautionary measure. The incident occurred at a unit of Bhageria Industries Ltd located in the Boisar MIDC industrial area on the outskirts of Mumbai.

20. In the remote Mudh Valley of Ladakh, a remarkable community-led conservation effort has been safeguarding ruddy shelducks and their young for over two decades. Each summer, villagers observe a unique natural spectacle: a pair of ruddy shelducks guiding their fledglings on a long journey from the valley to the Indus River.

21. Union Minister for Culture and Tourism Gajendra Singh Shekhawat emphasised India's commitment to building globally competitive, sustainable, and community-focused tourism destinations under the Vision 2047 framework. Addressing the UN Tourism Minister's Summit at ITB Berlin 2026, he outlined India's strategy for responsible and inclusive tourism growth.

22. The Adani Group has been named an official partner for the World Engineering Day for Sustainable Development (WED) 2026. The international observance is recognised by UNESCO and delivered by the World Federation of Engineering Organizations (WFEO). This marks the first time an Indian organisation has been selected by WFEO as a partner for this global platform that celebrates the role of engineers in sustainable development.

23. Tamil Nadu Governor R. N. Ravi has been appointed as the new Governor of West Bengal following the sudden resignation of C. V. Ananda Bose. The change comes just months before the 2026 West Bengal Assembly elections, drawing political attention across the country. Bose had served as the Governor of West Bengal since 2022.

24. A major administrative reshuffle has taken place in India's Union Territories as Ladakh Lieutenant Governor Kavinder Gupta resigned from his position after serving less than a year in office. Vinai Kumar Saxena, currently serving as the Lieutenant Governor of Delhi, has been appointed as the new Lieutenant Governor of Ladakh.

25. Korea district in Chhattisgarh has emerged as a notable example of community-led water conservation through the 'Jal Sanchay Jan Bhagidari' initiative. The programme encourages farmers to voluntarily allocate a small portion of their land for groundwater recharge and sustainable water management.

26. Senior diplomat Taranjit Singh Sandhu has been appointed as the new Lieutenant Governor (L-G) of Delhi following a gubernatorial reshuffle announced by the President of India. A seasoned Indian Foreign Service (IFS) officer, Sandhu previously served as India's ambassador to the United States and played a key role in strengthening India-US strategic relations.

27. India has taken a significant step towards conducting its first fully digital population census with the soft launch of new digital tools and mascots for Census 2027. Union Home Minister Amit Shah unveiled the initiatives in New Delhi, signalling the beginning of preparations for what is expected to be the world's largest enumeration exercise.

28. A rare pair of dusky eagle owls has been sighted in the Phato tourism zone of the Terai West forest division near Corbett Tiger Reserve in Uttarakhand. The discovery has generated excitement among conservationists and birdwatchers as the elusive species was last officially recorded in the region in 2010.

29. The High Court of Karnataka has directed the State government to include the remaining areas of the Kappatagudda reserve forest within the boundaries of the Kappatagudda Wildlife Sanctuary in Gadag district. The directive comes after the court observed that the existing notification issued in May 2019 declared only 244.15 square kilometres as a sanctuary, despite the

Karnataka State Wildlife Board (KSWB) having earlier approved a larger area for protection.

30. NITI Aayog has signed a Statement of Intent (SOI) with UNICEF India to strengthen health and nutrition interventions in aspirational districts and blocks across the country. The partnership aims to improve maternal and child nutrition outcomes in underserved regions by combining the expertise and institutional capacities of both organisations.

31. The Maharashtra government has signed a memorandum of understanding (MoU) with three Finnish companies to modernise Sassoon Dock in Mumbai and transform it into a technologically advanced and environmentally sustainable fishing harbour. The agreement, signed by the Maharashtra Fisheries Development Corporation, aims to upgrade infrastructure, improve waste management and introduce modern systems in one of India's oldest and most important fishing docks.

32. Union Home and Cooperation Minister Amit Shah dedicated the newly commissioned Sulphuric Acid Plant-III (SAP-III) at the Indian Farmers Fertiliser Cooperative Limited (IFFCO) complex in Paradeep, Odisha, to the nation on 7th March 2026. The facility is expected to strengthen fertiliser production capacity and support agricultural productivity across India.

33. Prime Minister Narendra Modi inaugurated two new corridors of the Delhi Metro, including India's first fully operational 'Ring Metro', marking a major milestone in the capital's urban transport network. The launch includes the Majlis Park-Maujpur-Babarpur corridor of the Pink Line and the Deepali Chowk-Majlis Park extension of the Magenta Line.

34. The Wildlife Wing of the Himachal Pradesh Forest Department has documented the presence of sambar deer in high-altitude protected areas of Chamba district for the first time. The discovery was made through camera trap monitoring and represents an important ecological observation, as the species is generally associated with lower Shivalik hills and moist deciduous forests.

35. The Narcotics Control Bureau (NCB) has dismantled a major pan-India drug distribution

network operating under the name "Team Kalki". The network allegedly used darknet marketplaces and encrypted communication platforms to distribute narcotic drugs and psychotropic substances across the country.

36. Prime Minister Narendra Modi will visit Kerala and Tamil Nadu on 11th March 2026, to inaugurate, dedicate to the nation, and lay foundation stones for multiple infrastructure and development projects worth over Rs. 16,450 crore. The projects span sectors such as petroleum and natural gas infrastructure, highways, railway connectivity, rural roads, and renewable energy.

37. The Protection of Plant Varieties and Farmer's Rights Authority (PPVFRA) has officially registered "Nagauri Paan Methi" as a Community Farmer's Variety. The announcement appeared in the February 2026 issue of the Plant Variety Journal. The registration grants statutory ownership and legal protection to the farming community of Nagaur district in Rajasthan.

38. The Forest Survey of India (FSI), the central agency responsible for monitoring the country's forest resources, has stopped issuing fortnightly deforestation alerts through its AI-based Anavaran portal. The system, which provided near-real-time alerts on forest cover loss using satellite data and machine learning, has not been updated since November 2025.

39. Rahul Bhatia, billionaire entrepreneur and co-founder of IndiGo, has taken charge as the airline's interim Chief Executive Officer following the resignation of Pieter Elbers. The move comes amid operational challenges faced by India's largest airline by market share.

40. The Ministry of Panchayati Raj will organise a one-day National Conference of Women Elected Representatives (WERs) of Panchayats on 11th March 2026 in New Delhi under the Sashakt Panchayat-Netri Abhiyan. The conference will bring together around 700 participants including women representatives from Panchayats across India, officials from government ministries and representatives from United Nations agencies.

41. The Supreme Court of India has permitted passive euthanasia in the Harish Rana case, reigniting debate on end-of-life medical decisions. The ruling highlights the legal and ethical distinction between passive euthanasia-allowing a patient to die by withdrawing life-sustaining treatment-and active euthanasia, which involves deliberate intervention to end life.

42. The Lok Sabha rejected a no-confidence motion brought by opposition parties seeking the removal of Speaker Om Birla after a heated debate and protests in the House. The motion was defeated through a voice vote, with the ruling Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) and its allies opposing the resolution. The proceedings witnessed loud sloganeering from opposition members before the House was adjourned for the day.

43. The Union Government has approved the renovation of the historic Bascule Bridge at the Syama Prasad Mookerjee Port in Kolkata. Union Minister of Ports, Shipping and Waterways Sarbananda Sonowal cleared the project with an estimated cost of Rs. 117.54 crore. The renovation aims to modernise the decades-old bridge and improve cargo and vehicular movement within the Kolkata Dock System, a key maritime hub in eastern India.

44. The Karnataka High Court has directed the state government to halt all ground-level activities within the Sharavathi Valley Lion-Tailed Macaque Sanctuary and its Eco-Sensitive Zone. The interim order was issued while hearing a public interest litigation (PIL) challenging the approval granted by the Karnataka State Wildlife Board for the proposed Sharavathi Pumped Storage Project and the construction of the Kalkatte Bridge.

45. President Droupadi Murmu inaugurated the Global Conference on Women in Agri-Food Systems 2026 in New Delhi. The three-day international conference will be held at the Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR) Convention Centre with the theme "Driving Progress, Attaining New Heights".

46. NITI Aayog has released the second edition of the Fiscal Health Index (FHI) 2026 to assess the fiscal performance of Indian states. The report was

unveiled in New Delhi by Suman Bery, Vice-Chairman of NITI Aayog, and Nidhi Chhibber, Chief Executive Officer of NITI Aayog. The index serves as a data-driven framework designed to evaluate fiscal soundness, promote transparency and support evidence-based fiscal policymaking across states.

47. The Unique Identification Authority of India (UIDAI) has introduced its first structured Bug Bounty Programme to enhance the security of the Aadhaar ecosystem. The initiative invites cybersecurity experts to identify vulnerabilities in key UIDAI digital platforms and report them responsibly.

48. The Delhi Cantonment Board (DCB) has introduced the Swachhata Monitoring & Automated Reporting Tool (SMART) to improve monitoring and transparency in sanitation and civic services. The digital platform aims to address long-standing issues such as manual reporting, delayed data collection and fragmented monitoring systems.

49. A rare sighting of a male blue-and-white flycatcher has been reported from Pavagadh Hill in Gujarat, drawing attention from bird watchers and forest officials. The small migratory bird, known for its striking royal blue upperparts, black face and breast, and white belly, was photographed by a team of forest officials during a field visit to collect tree seeds in the forest area.

50. Assam has achieved a major milestone in promoting its agricultural products globally with the export of its Geographical Indication (GI)-tagged Joha rice to the United Kingdom and Italy. A consignment of 25 metric tonnes of the aromatic rice was dispatched from Guwahati, marking the first large-scale export of the traditional variety to European markets.

51. The Supreme Court has ruled that parental income alone cannot be used as the sole criterion to determine whether a candidate belongs to the 'creamy layer' within the Other Backward Classes (OBC) category. The judgment emphasised that the status and category of the parent's employment must also be considered while deciding eligibility for reservation benefits.

52. Union Minister for Law and Justice Arjun Ram Meghwal participated in the 12th Asian and Pacific Regional Conference organised by the All India Prosecutor's Association in New Delhi. The conference brought together legal experts, prosecutors, and judicial professionals from across the region to discuss key developments and challenges in the justice delivery system.

53. The Union Minister of State (Independent Charge) for Ayush, Prataprao Jadhav, inaugurated Yoga Mahotsav-2026 in New Delhi, formally launching the 100-day countdown to the 12th International Day of Yoga (IDY) to be celebrated in 2026. Organised by the Ministry of Ayush, the event aims to promote the global movement of Yoga as a tool for holistic health, well-being and mental balance.

54. The Department of Fisheries, Government of India, organised the National Conference on Cold Water Fisheries at the Sher-e-Kashmir International Conference Centre (SKICC) in Srinagar, Jammu and Kashmir. The conference brought together policymakers, researchers, industry experts and stakeholders to discuss strategies for sustainable development of India's cold water fisheries sector.

55. Union Home Secretary Govind Mohan inaugurated the National Dialogue on Online Crimes Against Women and Children (OCWC) in New Delhi, highlighting the growing need for stronger coordination and institutional capacity to address cyber offences targeting vulnerable groups.

56. The Karnataka State Road Transport Corporation (KSRTC) has been honoured with the Governance Now 12th PSU National Award in the "Excellence in Innovation" category for its accessibility initiative titled "Dhwani Spandana". The award recognises the corporation's efforts to improve public transport accessibility for visually impaired passengers.

57. The Directorate of Revenue Intelligence (DRI) recently uncovered a clandestine facility involved in the illegal production of Alprazolam in Andhra Pradesh. The seizure highlights ongoing efforts by Indian authorities to curb the illegal manufacturing and trafficking of psychotropic substances.

58. Researchers from Gauhati University have discovered a new plant species named "Osbeckia zubeengargiana" in Assam. The discovery was made in the grasslands of Manas National Park located in the Baksa district. The species has attracted attention because it has been named after noted Assamese singer Zubeen Garg, marking a rare instance where a botanical discovery honours a cultural icon.

59. The Centre for Development of Telematics (C-DOT) organised a Demo Day in New Delhi for 18 startups participating in the second cohort of the Samarth incubation programme. Held at the NBCC Convention Hall, the event showcased innovative technological solutions developed by startups working in fields such as telecommunications, cybersecurity, artificial intelligence, Internet of Things (IoT), 5G and 6G technologies, and quantum technologies.

60. Union Minister of Communications and Development of North Eastern Region, Jyotiraditya M. Scindia, inaugurated the Samridhhi Kendra in Umri village of Guna district, Madhya Pradesh, under the Samridhhi Gram Phygital Services Pilot Initiative of the Department of Telecommunications (DoT).

61. Prime Minister Narendra Modi inaugurated the Haldia Bulk Terminal, a fully automated dry bulk handling facility developed by Adani Ports and Special Economic Zone Limited (APSEZ) at the Haldia Dock Complex of Syama Prasad Mookerjee Port in Kolkata. The project marks a major addition to India's eastern maritime infrastructure and is expected to improve cargo handling efficiency along the Hooghly river.

62. Botanists from Gauhati University have discovered a new plant species in the grasslands of Manas National Park in Assam and named it after renowned Assamese singer Zubeen Garg. The discovery highlights the rich biodiversity of the region and adds to the growing list of plant species identified from the ecologically significant national park.

63. Illegal earth cutting from a wetland connected to Deepor Beel is continuing in the Satmile area of Guwahati despite prohibitory orders issued by the

district administration, restrictions from the Gauhati High Court and regulations enforced by the Assam Forest Department.

64. Several historic monuments and civic landmarks in Hyderabad have been identified as part of the proposed Musi River rejuvenation project. Authorities are exploring ways to integrate these heritage sites into a cultural tourism corridor along the river. The plan aims to combine river restoration with heritage conservation, highlighting the historic role of the Musi River in shaping Hyderabad's urban and cultural landscape.

65. A medieval Telugu inscription linked to the Gajapathi rulers of Odisha has been discovered on a stone pillar at the historic Lakshmi Narasimha Swamy Temple in Ramachandrapura Agraharam of Guntur city. The inscription offers valuable insights into the political and cultural connections between the Odisha region and coastal Andhra during the late medieval period.

66. Kusunpur village in Odisha's Kendrapada district is set to become the state's first "smart village" under a technology-driven rural development initiative led by the Council of Scientific and Industrial Research (CSIR). The project aims to integrate modern technologies into everyday life and agriculture, creating a sustainable and self-reliant rural ecosystem.

67. The National Democratic Alliance (NDA) secured a clean sweep in the Rajya Sabha elections from Bihar, winning all five seats that were up for election. Among the winners was Bihar Chief Minister Nitish Kumar, along with BJP state president Nitin Nabin, Union minister Ram Nath Thakur, Rashtriya Lok Morcha (RLM) president Upendra Kushwaha, and BJP state general secretary Shivesh Kumar.

68. The Union Government has withdrawn the Jan Vishwas (Amendment of Provisions) Bill, 2025 from the Lok Sabha to incorporate recommendations made by a Select Committee. The move reflects the government's intent to refine the proposed changes before reintroducing the legislation aimed at decriminalising minor offences and promoting trust-based governance.

69. The India Tourism Development Corporation (ITDC), under the Ministry of Tourism, in collaboration with the Ministry of Tribal Affairs, inaugurated a Capacity Building Programme for Tribal Homestay Owners in New Delhi. The initiative marks a significant step towards promoting community-based tourism while enhancing the professional capabilities of tribal homestay operators across India.

70. The Tribal Cooperative Marketing Development Federation of India (TRIFED), in collaboration with the Ministry of Tribal Affairs, is organising Bharat Tribes Fest 2026 from 18th to 30th March at Sunder Nursery, New Delhi. The festival aims to celebrate the diversity, creativity and entrepreneurial strength of tribal communities across India. It was inaugurated by Union Minister for Tribal Affairs Jai Prakash Singh in the presence of Minister of State Durgadas Ukey.

71. India is preparing to tackle the growing challenge of solar panel waste, with estimates suggesting that cumulative waste from installed and upcoming solar capacity could reach nearly 600 kilo-tonnes by 2030. The projection, supported by the Ministry of New and Renewable Energy (MNRE) and research by the Council on Energy, Environment and Water.

72. An Indian-flagged crude oil tanker, Jag Laadki, has successfully docked at Mundra Port in Gujarat, strengthening India's energy supply amid rising tensions in West Asia. The vessel carried around 80,886 metric tonnes of crude oil sourced from the United Arab Emirates, highlighting the resilience of India's maritime logistics and energy import network.

73. The Union Cabinet, chaired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, has approved the Small Hydro Power (SHP) Development Scheme for the period FY 2026-27 to FY 2030-31. With an outlay of Rs. 2,584.60 crore, the scheme aims to develop approximately 1,500 MW of small hydro capacity across the country.

74. The National Cooperative Development Corporation (NCDC), functioning under the Ministry of Cooperation, has introduced the 'Dirghavadhi Krishak Punji Sahakar Yojana' to

strengthen long-term credit availability for cooperatives engaged in agriculture and allied sectors. The scheme aims to support capital formation, improve rural infrastructure, and ensure a steady flow of institutional finance to cooperative societies.

75. The hill region surrounding Kalinjar Fort in Banda district, Uttar Pradesh, has been officially designated as a National Geo-Heritage Site by the Geological Survey of India (GSI) on 16th March 2026. This recognition highlights the area's exceptional geological significance along with its rich historical and cultural legacy.

76. In line with the declaration of 2026 as the International Year of the Woman Farmer by the United Nations through the Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO), the Agriculture Insurance Company of India Limited (AIC) has launched the 'Krishi Sakhi Initiative'. The programme aims to empower women farmers, enhance their participation in agriculture and promote inclusive growth in the sector.

77. The Meghalaya government has extended the tenure of the Garo Hills Autonomous District Council (GHADC) by six months following unrest in the Garo Hills region. The decision was taken during a State Cabinet meeting held in Shillong, amid protests over the participation of non-tribals in the council's electoral process.

78. Amid rising geopolitical tensions in West Asia and disruptions in maritime logistics, the Government of India has approved a targeted intervention named RELIEF (Resilience & Logistics Intervention for Export Facilitation) under the Export Promotion Mission (EPM). The move aims to support exporters affected by escalating freight costs, higher insurance premiums and operational uncertainties linked to disruptions around the Strait of Hormuz and the wider Gulf region.

79. The Maharashtra Goseva Commission, in partnership with the Global Confederation of Cow-Based Industries (GCCBI) and several service organisations, is organising 'Gau-Tech 2026' from 20th to 23rd March at the Agriculture College in Pune. The exhibition aims to promote cow-based

agriculture, strengthen rural livelihoods and expand market opportunities linked to traditional and emerging village industries.

80. Veteran Malayalam actor and director E. A. Rajendran passed away at the age of 71 at his residence in Kollam after prolonged age-related ailments. Known for his versatile performances across films, television, and theatre, his demise marks the end of a distinguished artistic journey in the Malayalam entertainment industry.

81. The Ministry of Road Transport and Highways has launched the PRISM-SG Portal in New Delhi to enhance efficiency and coordination in infrastructure development. The digital platform focuses on streamlining processes related to the construction of Road Over Bridges (ROBs) and railway bridges, addressing delays and improving transparency in approvals and inspections.

82. Indian Railways has approved infrastructure projects worth Rs. 1,236 crore to strengthen its communication systems and expand the indigenous Kavach train protection system across key routes. The initiative focuses on enhancing safety, improving operational efficiency and building a robust digital backbone for railway operations across multiple zones.

83. India has strengthened its climate commitments by announcing updated targets under its Nationally Determined Contributions (NDC), aiming for significant progress by 2035. The revised goals include achieving 60% of installed electricity capacity from non-fossil sources, reducing emissions intensity of GDP by 47% from 2005 levels, and expanding carbon sinks to 3.5-4 billion tonnes of CO₂ equivalent.

84. The Lok Sabha has passed the Finance Bill 2026 by a voice vote, approving 33 amendments proposed by the government and rejecting those moved by Opposition members. With this, the Bill moves to the Rajya Sabha for final approval, after which the Union Budget process for 2026-27 will be formally completed.

85. The Delhi High Court has ruled that a second wife is not entitled to family pension if the marriage was void at its inception, even if the first legally

wedded wife dies later. The judgment reinforces the principle that pensionary benefits are strictly governed by legal marital status under applicable service rules, particularly the Pension Regulations for the Army, 1961.

86. External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar participated in the G7 Foreign Minister's Meeting in France, where global governance, geopolitical tensions, and economic stability dominated discussions. The meeting comes at a time of heightened uncertainty due to the ongoing crisis in West Asia, which has significant implications for global energy markets and supply chains.

87. India is accelerating efforts to achieve self-reliance in tulip cultivation through a major initiative in Kashmir. The move aims to reduce dependence on imported tulip bulbs and establish a sustainable domestic supply chain. With growing demand for ornamental flowers and tourism-linked horticulture, the project is gaining strategic importance in the Valley's agricultural landscape.

88. A recent study has documented the use of 39 medicinal plants by the Sonowal Kachari community to treat various ailments such as fever, cough, kidney stones, and skin diseases. This highlights the rich traditional knowledge system of indigenous communities in northeast India and their contribution to ethnobotany and healthcare practices.

89. The Ministry of Information and Broadcasting (MIB) has notified a new Television Rating Policy aimed at enhancing transparency, accountability, and independence in audience measurement. The policy introduces structural reforms in rating agencies, strengthens audit mechanisms, and expands the scale of data collection to improve reliability.

90. Meghalaya has become the twelfth State to sign a reform-linked Memorandum of Understanding with the Union Government under Jal Jeevan Mission (JJM) 2.0. The agreement marks a shift towards outcome-based and service-driven rural water supply. Approved by the Union Cabinet in March 2026, JJM 2.0 focuses on sustainability, decentralisation, and long-term water security across rural India.

91. The Government of India has reduced excise duty on petrol and diesel to shield consumers and oil marketing companies from surging global crude prices. The decision comes as international oil prices have sharply increased due to ongoing geopolitical tensions in West Asia, significantly impacting domestic fuel costs.

92. The Government has outlined multiple measures to improve the water quality of the Damanganga river, focusing on industrial compliance and pollution control. As per the Gujarat Pollution Control Board (GPCB), technical corrective actions are currently under implementation. However, legal proceedings related to earlier National Green Tribunal directions remain stayed by the Supreme Court.

93. The Central Government has prioritised women's safety through legislative and policy measures, notably the Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal) Act, 2013. The law aims to safeguard women from workplace harassment and ensure effective mechanisms for prevention and redressal.

94. The Ministry of Rural Development has highlighted the growing importance of Rural Self Employment Training Institutes (RSETIs) in empowering rural youth. These institutions are playing a crucial role in promoting skill development, entrepreneurship and sustainable livelihoods across India.

95. A massive snow avalanche has recently struck Zojila Pass in Ladakh, disrupting movement along a key Himalayan corridor. The incident highlights the vulnerability of high-altitude mountain passes to extreme weather events and their impact on connectivity between Kashmir and Ladakh.

96. The Red-crowned Roofed Turtle, once widely found in the Ganga river system, is now confined to shrinking habitats, raising serious conservation concerns. This freshwater species, known for its ecological importance, is witnessing rapid population decline due to habitat degradation, pollution and human interference.

97. A recent outbreak of shigellosis has been reported in Kerala, raising public health concerns

due to its highly contagious nature. The infection, caused by Shigella bacteria, is a major contributor to diarrhoeal diseases, particularly in regions with challenges in sanitation and hygiene.

98. India continues to account for a substantial share of global maternal deaths, according to a recent study published in a leading medical journal. Despite notable progress over the past decades, the pace of improvement has slowed after 2015. The findings highlight both achievements and persistent gaps in maternal healthcare across the country.

99. Senior Maoist commander Chelluru Narayana Rao, also known as Somanna, surrendered before Andhra Pradesh Police in Vijayawada, marking a significant development in anti-insurgency efforts in the region. His surrender, along with several other Maoist cadres, is seen as a major setback to Maoist operations in the Andhra-Odisha Border (AOB) area.

100. Prime Minister Narendra Modi inaugurated Phase I of the Noida International Airport (NIA) at Jewar in Uttar Pradesh on 28th March, marking a major milestone in India's aviation infrastructure expansion. The airport, located along the Yamuna Expressway in Gautam Buddha Nagar, is set to become the second international airport serving the Delhi-NCR region after Indira Gandhi International Airport.

101. The Telangana Assembly has passed the 'Telangana Employees Accountability and Monitoring of Parental Support Bill, 2026', aimed at strengthening financial security for senior citizens. The legislation mandates that employees and public representatives ensure proper care and financial support for their elderly parents, marking a significant step in social welfare policy.

102. The Archaeological Survey of India (ASI) has recently initiated fresh excavation work at the historically significant Balirajgarh site in Bihar's Madhubani district. The move aims to uncover deeper insights into ancient civilisations and strengthen understanding of early cultural and administrative centres in the region.

103. In the latest episode of Mann Ki Baat, Prime Minister Narendra Modi highlighted Tripura's

success in community-led water conservation and sustainable development. He praised the transformation of Vangmun village in the Jampui Hills, which has emerged as a model for tackling water scarcity through local participation and innovative practices.

104. At least nine people have lost their lives in a stampede at the Sheetla Mata Temple in Bihar's Nalanda district on 31st March 2026. The incident occurred during routine Tuesday prayers, when a large number of devotees had gathered at the temple in Maghada village. Authorities fear that the death toll may rise further as rescue and identification efforts continue.

105. The Centre is set to introduce the Andhra Pradesh Reorganisation (Amendment) Bill, 2026 in the Lok Sabha to formally recognise Amaravati as the sole capital of Andhra Pradesh. The move aims to provide statutory backing to the greenfield capital project and bring clarity to the long-standing capital issue in the State.

106. The Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change has designated the "Bhavasagara" Referral Centre as a National Repository for Deep-Sea Fauna, marking a significant step in strengthening India's marine biodiversity conservation framework. The recognition enhances the country's capacity to systematically document and preserve deep-sea biological resources under a legal and scientific framework.

107. Varkala, a coastal town in Kerala, has been included in the inaugural "20 Cities Towards Zero Waste" initiative, highlighting India's growing commitment to sustainable urban development.

The initiative recognises cities worldwide that are adopting innovative strategies to minimise waste and transition towards circular economy models.

108. Prime Minister Narendra Modi inaugurated a semiconductor manufacturing facility of Kaynes Technology in Sanand, Gujarat, marking a significant step in India's ambition to build a robust domestic chip ecosystem. The development reflects accelerating momentum in the country's semiconductor sector, following recent milestones in chip manufacturing.

109. India is set to conduct its first fully digital population census, with the initial phase beginning on 1st April 2026. Announced by the Registrar General and Census Commissioner, the exercise will mark the 16th census since inception and the eighth after Independence.

110. India will implement a major regulatory shift in its surveillance sector from 1st April 2026, banning the sale of non-certified internet-connected CCTV cameras, particularly those linked to Chinese manufacturers. The move marks the end of a two-year transition period aimed at strengthening national security and reducing reliance on foreign technology in critical infrastructure.

111. The Navegaon-Nagzira Tiger Reserve (NNTR) in Maharashtra's Gondia district will assume control over its notified buffer area from 1st April, marking a significant step in strengthening wildlife conservation and habitat management. The move is expected to enhance protection measures and improve coordination in managing human-wildlife interactions around the reserve.

International

1. A 14th-century shipwreck discovered in the waters off Singapore has revealed a vast cargo of blue-and-white Yuan Dynasty porcelain, offering fresh insights into maritime trade during the Mongol Empire. The vessel, believed to have been sailing from China to Temasek, the historic settlement located on the site of modern-day Singapore, dates back roughly 650 years.

2. Deep within Brazil's Amazon rainforest, the Amondawa tribe lives without a conventional understanding of time as defined by modern civilisation. Researchers have found that the indigenous community has no linguistic or cultural equivalent for words such as "time", "week", "month" or "year". Their daily lives are structured around natural cycles rather than clocks or calendars.

3. A viral disease causing rot in cassava roots is raising alarm across sub-Saharan Africa, threatening a staple crop relied upon by millions for food security and income. Cassava, prized for its tolerance to drought and poor soils, serves as a critical safety net for vulnerable households. However, scientists warn that the spread of Cassava Brown Streak Disease (CBSD) could severely undermine this resilience.

4. Scotland has become the first nation in the United Kingdom to legalise water cremation, formally known as alkaline hydrolysis. The move marks a significant reform in funeral legislation, representing the most substantial change since cremation was introduced in Scotland in 1902. The new rules were approved by the Scottish Parliament amid growing demand for environmentally sustainable end-of-life options.

5. Mojtaba Hosseini Khamenei, the son of Iran's long-time Supreme Leader Ayatollah Ali Khamenei, has reportedly been chosen as the country's next Supreme Leader following his father's death in a joint United States-Israel strike.

6. Scientists exploring the deep Pacific Ocean have reported the discovery of what they describe as "dark oxygen", detected about 4,000 metres below the ocean surface where sunlight never reaches.

The finding challenges the long-standing scientific understanding that oxygen on Earth is primarily produced through photosynthesis, a process that requires sunlight.

7. Chile has become the first country in the Americas to be officially verified by the World Health Organization (WHO) for eliminating leprosy as a public health problem. The recognition follows more than three decades without locally transmitted cases, marking a major milestone in global disease control efforts. Chile's last locally acquired case of the disease was recorded in 1993.

8. Childhood obesity in India has reached alarming levels, according to the World Obesity Atlas 2026 released on 4th March to mark World Obesity Day. The report estimates that nearly 15 million children aged five to nine and over 26 million adolescents aged 10 to 19 in India were overweight or obese in 2025.

9. The United States Supreme Court has struck down tariffs imposed by President Donald Trump in 2025, ruling that the President lacked constitutional authority to impose such taxes without approval from Congress. The landmark 6-3 judgment is being widely viewed as a significant affirmation of the rule of law and the constitutional separation of powers in the United States.

10. Japan has approved a groundbreaking stem-cell therapy for Parkinson's disease, marking a major milestone in regenerative medicine. The Japanese government also cleared a similar treatment for severe heart failure, potentially making them the world's first commercially available medical products based on induced pluripotent stem (iPS) cells.

11. The United States military conducted a successful test launch of its Minuteman III intercontinental ballistic missile (ICBM) off the coast of California. The launch was carried out by the Air Force Global Strike Command to evaluate the operational performance and reliability of the missile system.

12. The United States has announced a major tactical shift in its ongoing military campaign against Iran. US Defence Secretary Pete Hegseth stated that Iranian air defence systems have been significantly weakened after several days of operations. As a result, the US military plans to deploy precision-guided gravity bombs weighing 500, 1,000 and 2,000 pounds.

13. Nepal's political landscape appears poised for a major transformation as Balendra Shah, widely known as Balen Shah, has emerged as a strong contender for the country's prime ministership following the latest general election trends. The 35-year-old Kathmandu mayor and former rapper represents a new generation of leadership challenging the dominance of traditional political elites.

14. Health officials in the United States have reported a recent rise in mumps cases, drawing attention to another vaccine-preventable disease after measles. In Maryland, authorities confirmed 26 cases of mumps so far in 2026, including 19 confirmed and seven probable infections. Nationally, the US Centers for Disease Control and Prevention (CDC) recorded 34 cases across 11 jurisdictions by late February.

15. A rapid recovery of koala populations in southeastern Australia has led to a surprising increase in their genetic variation, offering new hope for species recovering from near extinction. A recent study published in "Science" highlights how the rebound of koalas in the Australian state of Victoria has reshuffled genetic combinations, potentially improving their ability to adapt and survive in the long term. The findings suggest that even species that pass through severe population declines can gradually regain genetic resilience if their numbers recover quickly.

16. Escalating military tensions between the United States and Iran have created a new aviation risk across the skies of the Persian Gulf and the United Arab Emirates. Commercial aircraft operating in the region are increasingly facing GPS spoofing incidents, where navigation systems receive manipulated signals that display false positions.

17. India has emerged as the fourth most preferred global destination for cross-border investments in land and development sites, according to Collier's Global Capital Flows Report released in September 2025. The ranking highlights India's growing importance in the international real estate investment landscape. Despite broader economic uncertainties affecting the Asia-Pacific (APAC) property market, investor confidence in India's real estate sector remains resilient.

18. The United States is reportedly considering the possibility of capturing Iran's Kharg Island, a move aimed at restricting Tehran's oil revenues amid escalating tensions in the Middle East. The island is Iran's primary oil export hub and a vital component of its energy infrastructure. Discussions within the US administration indicate that targeting this strategic location could weaken Iran's financial capacity and reduce its ability to sustain military activities during the ongoing conflict.

19. Human Rights Watch (HRW) has accused Israel of unlawfully using white phosphorus munitions over residential areas in southern Lebanon during recent military operations. The allegation comes amid escalating tensions along the Israel-Lebanon border following renewed clashes involving Hezbollah.

20. Two giant oarfish were recently spotted near the shoreline of Cabo San Lucas, a coastal city in Mexico, in a rare marine encounter that has attracted widespread attention. Beachgoers first noticed one oarfish struggling close to the shore and attempted to guide it back into deeper waters. Oarfish are deep-sea creatures that are rarely seen near the ocean surface.

21. The North Atlantic Treaty Organization (NATO) has launched its biennial Arctic military exercise named "Cold Response", beginning on 9th March and continuing until 19th March 2026. The drills are being conducted amid heightened geopolitical tensions in the Arctic region, particularly following recent discussions surrounding Greenland's strategic importance.

22. Several historic monuments and UNESCO-listed heritage sites in Iran have reportedly suffered damage following recent US and Israeli military

strikes. Although the missiles did not directly hit the cultural landmarks, shockwaves from nearby explosions and falling debris caused structural damage to delicate architectural features such as glass panels, tiles, and stonework.

23. India has co-sponsored a resolution at the United Nations Security Council condemning attacks carried out by Iran against Gulf Cooperation Council (GCC) countries and Jordan. The resolution called for the immediate cessation of hostilities and warned against threats to close the strategically important Strait of Hormuz.

24. India has emerged as the largest supplier of cotton products such as apparel and home textiles to the United States in 2025, surpassing China for the first time in recent years. The development reflects changing global trade patterns driven by tariffs, supply chain diversification, and regulatory concerns affecting Chinese exports.

25. India's Centre for Development of Telematics (C-DOT) received global recognition at the Mobile World Congress (MWC) 2026 in Barcelona, Spain, for its indigenous artificial intelligence-based fraud detection solution called "Fraud Pro". The innovation was shortlisted as a top finalist at the Global Mobile Awards (GLOMO) in the category of Best Network Security and Fraud Prevention.

26. China has enacted a new law aimed at strengthening national unity by promoting a shared national identity among its diverse ethnic communities. The legislation, titled "Promoting Ethnic Unity and Progress", was approved by the National People's Congress with an overwhelming majority.

27. Recent research has confirmed that the Silverpit Crater in the North Sea was created by a massive asteroid impact millions of years ago. Scientists analysed geological samples and identified mineral evidence associated with high-energy space impacts. The finding strengthens earlier theories that the structure beneath the seabed is a genuine impact crater rather than a geological formation caused by other processes.

28. The International Day of Mathematics (IDM) is observed annually on 14th March to celebrate the

importance of mathematics in everyday life, science, and technology. The day has been celebrated globally since 2020 after it was proclaimed by UNESCO.

29. Zydus Lifesciences has received marketing approval in China for its drug Desidustat, used to treat anaemia in patients suffering from Chronic Kidney Disease (CKD). The approval was granted by China's drug regulator, the National Medical Products Administration (NMPA), marking a significant step for the Ahmedabad-based pharmaceutical company as it enters one of the world's largest healthcare markets.

30. Pi Day is celebrated every year on 14th March to honour the mathematical constant π (pi), one of the most important numbers in mathematics. The date 3/14 in the American format corresponds to the first three digits of pi, 3.14. The day highlights the role of mathematics in understanding patterns, shapes, and the structure of the universe.

31. Iran has reportedly deployed its Sejil ballistic missile for the first time during the ongoing conflict in West Asia. The missile was launched as part of a wave of attacks under Iran's "Operation True Promise 4", targeting Israeli military and administrative infrastructure.

32. The World Bank has approved a loan of about USD 300 million to support Uttar Pradesh's efforts to improve air quality through a comprehensive clean air transition programme. The funding will support the Uttar Pradesh Clean Air Management Program, which aims to address pollution across sectors such as transport, agriculture, and industry.

33. The Government of India has relaxed foreign direct investment (FDI) rules to allow overseas companies with up to 10% Chinese shareholding to invest in India through the automatic route. The change was notified by the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT) and aims to ease investment flows while retaining safeguards against strategic risks.

34. A recent agreement between Sentyln Therapeutics, a subsidiary of Zydus Lifesciences, and South Korea's PRG S&T marks a significant step towards developing Progerinin, an oral drug

aimed at treating Hutchinson-Gilford Progeria Syndrome (HGPS). This rare genetic disorder leads to accelerated ageing in children and remains one of the most severe paediatric conditions with no definitive cure so far.

35. Several Gulf energy producers have recently declared force majeure on oil and gas shipments following disruptions in maritime traffic through the Strait of Hormuz. This development has significant implications for global energy supply chains, highlighting the importance of contractual safeguards in times of unforeseen crises.

36. Gobekli Tepe, located in present-day Turkey, is regarded as the world's oldest known temple complex, dating back to around 9600 BCE. Built nearly 12,000 years ago, the site predates agriculture, pottery and urban settlements. Its discovery has fundamentally reshaped understanding of early human civilisation, suggesting that organised religious activity may have preceded settled life.

37. Archaeologists have uncovered compelling evidence of a highly organised Neanderthal activity site dating back nearly 1,25,000 years in present-day Germany. The discovery at Neumark-Nord near Leipzig suggests that Neanderthals systematically processed animal bones for fat extraction, challenging long-standing assumptions about their cognitive and survival capabilities.

38. Brazil has begun enforcing a new law aimed at regulating minor's access to social media and online platforms, marking a significant step in global efforts to safeguard children in the digital space. The legislation, which came into effect this week, follows concerns over online exploitation and harmful content exposure among young users in the country.

39. Bhumika Shrestha, a 37-year-old LGBTQ rights activist, has made history by becoming Nepal's first transgender woman member of parliament. Her appointment marks a significant milestone in South Asia's journey towards inclusivity and representation of marginalised communities.

40. The World Happiness Report 2026, released on 18th March, has highlighted the adverse impact of excessive social media use on young people's well-being across several countries. The report, backed by the United Nations, also ranked Finland as the happiest country in the world for the ninth consecutive year, continuing the dominance of Nordic nations in global happiness rankings.

41. The Bharat Electricity Summit 2026, a major global conference-cum-exhibition for the power sector, is being held from 19th to 22nd March 2026 at Yashobhoomi in New Delhi. The event is expected to attract over 25,000 visitors, with participation from more than 80 countries, making it one of the largest global platforms focused on electricity and clean energy.

42. India and Vietnam have strengthened bilateral cooperation in tribal and ethnic development following a high-level ministerial meeting held in New Delhi on 20th March 2026. The meeting marked an important step in elevating engagement between the two countries, building on earlier official-level discussions and reinforcing their Comprehensive Strategic Partnership.

43. India and Indonesia have announced a collaborative initiative to restore the historic Prambanan Temple complex in the Special Region of Yogyakarta, marking a significant step in cultural diplomacy and heritage conservation. The partnership highlights shared civilisational ties and aims to preserve one of Southeast Asia's most iconic Hindu architectural sites.

44. Israel has announced plans to take control of southern Lebanon up to the Litani River to establish a "security zone". The move comes amid rising regional tensions and has renewed focus on Lebanon's geography and strategic significance in West Asia. The Litani River, a key geographical feature, plays a central role in the region's security and economic landscape.

45. The United States is set to introduce a historic change to its paper currency, with future dollar notes expected to carry the signature of President Donald Trump. The move, announced by the US Treasury Department, marks a significant departure from long-standing convention, as it will

be the first instance of a sitting president's signature appearing on American banknotes.

46. Tajikistan and Uzbekistan have proposed the inclusion of the striped hyena in Appendix I and Appendix II of the Convention on the Conservation of Migratory Species of Wild Animals (CMS). The proposal will be discussed at the 15th Meeting of the Conference of the Parties (CMS COP15) scheduled to take place in Campo Grande, Brazil, from 23rd to 29th March.

47. Nepal has witnessed a significant political transition as Sushila Karki, the country's first woman prime minister, stepped down after leading the nation through a turbulent phase. A former chief justice, she had come out of retirement to assume the interim leadership following violent anti-corruption protests in 2025 that toppled the government.

48. Iran has recently drawn global attention after reportedly firing Qader cruise missiles towards the USS Abraham Lincoln aircraft carrier. This development highlights the growing importance of anti-ship missile systems in modern naval warfare and reflects advancements in Iran's indigenous missile capabilities.

49. The Organisation for Economic Cooperation and Development (OECD) has projected India's economic growth at 6.1% for the financial year 2026-27. This forecast reflects continued global confidence in India's economic resilience despite external uncertainties such as inflationary pressures and geopolitical tensions.

50. A magnitude 6.2 earthquake recently struck off the east coast of Honshu, Japan's largest and most significant island. The event highlights the region's high seismic vulnerability due to its location along active tectonic plate boundaries within the Pacific Ring of Fire.

51. A recent development in global healthcare has brought attention to Lyme disease, as pharmaceutical companies Pfizer and Valneva announced that their experimental vaccine demonstrated over 70% efficacy in late-stage clinical trials. This progress offers hope in

combating a disease that is increasingly reported across multiple regions.

52. Japan has introduced the world's first dedicated freight-only Shinkansen, transforming its iconic bullet train into a high-speed cargo carrier. Operated by East Japan Railway Company, the initiative reflects a shift in logistics strategy, combining speed, efficiency, and sustainability to meet growing demands in supply chains.

53. China has reportedly deployed over 200 modified J-6 fighter jets, converted into unmanned attack drones, near the Taiwan Strait. The move signals a shift in Beijing's military strategy, emphasising large-scale, cost-effective systems designed to overwhelm enemy defences amid rising global geopolitical tensions.

54. The Maldives has reiterated its claim over the Chagos Islands, rejecting the United Kingdom's decision to transfer the archipelago to Mauritius. President Mohamed Muizzu's government has formally communicated that it does not recognise the proposed arrangement, asserting that Maldivian interests must be considered in any decision regarding sovereignty.

55. Ukraine and Qatar have signed a defence cooperation agreement during President Volodymyr Zelenskyy's official visit to Doha, marking a step forward in bilateral ties. The agreement reflects growing engagement between the two nations amid ongoing geopolitical tensions and Ukraine's continued conflict with Russia.

56. Officials of the Wildlife Management Authority and Coringa Wildlife Sanctuary in Andhra Pradesh have successfully conserved nearly 20,000 eggs of Olive Ridley turtles on Hope Island. This effort highlights the ecological importance of coastal habitats and ongoing conservation initiatives to protect vulnerable marine species.

57. India has proposed a draft ministerial declaration at the World Trade Organization (WTO) seeking stronger commitments on the transfer of advanced technologies to developing and least developed countries. The proposal was circulated ahead of the WTO's 14th Ministerial

Conference (MC14), scheduled to take place in Yaoundé, Cameroon, from 26th to 29th March.

58. India and Malta held the fourth round of Foreign Office Consultations (FOC) in Valletta on 27th March 2026, reviewing the full spectrum of bilateral relations and identifying new avenues for cooperation. The discussions reflected a growing momentum in ties, particularly as both nations marked 60 years of diplomatic relations in 2025.

59. Parts of Western Australia witnessed dramatic red skies as a powerful dust storm swept across the region ahead of Tropical Cyclone Narelle. The unusual visual, reported in areas such as Shark Bay and Denham, created an eerie atmosphere with daylight turning crimson and visibility dropping sharply. The phenomenon drew global attention due to its intensity and striking appearance.

60. Air China has resumed direct flights between Beijing and Pyongyang after a six-year suspension, signalling a gradual reopening of North Korea following prolonged pandemic-related isolation. The move reflects improving connectivity between the two neighbouring countries and hints at cautious economic normalisation in the region.

61. Indonesia has become the first country in Southeast Asia to ban social media access for children under the age of 16, marking a major step in global efforts to regulate digital platforms. The policy came into force on 28th March 2026 and is expected to impact nearly 70 million children, reflecting growing concern over online safety and mental health.

62. Zimbabwe is planning a 500 MW floating solar power project at Kariba Dam to address persistent electricity shortages and diversify its energy mix. The initiative, led by Green Hybrid Power in partnership with the Intensive Energy Users Group, marks a significant step towards strengthening energy security while promoting sustainable development.

63. The Government of Russia has announced a ban on gasoline exports starting 1st April 2026, in a move aimed at securing domestic fuel availability and controlling rising prices. The decision comes amid global oil market volatility triggered by ongoing geopolitical tensions in West Asia.

64. A newly observed COVID-19 variant, BA.3.2- commonly referred to as "Cicada"-is gradually increasing in detection across several regions worldwide. Health authorities indicate that the variant had been circulating at low levels for an extended period before its recent rise in visibility. Its name reflects this prolonged hidden presence, similar to cicadas that remain underground for years before emerging.

65. The 15th Conference of Parties (COP15) to the Convention on the Conservation of Migratory Species of Wild Animals (CMS) has expanded its protected list by adding forty new species. This development reflects growing global concern over declining migratory species and reinforces international cooperation for biodiversity conservation.

66. Prime Minister Narendra Modi expressed deep sorrow over the sudden demise of former Suriname President Chandrikapersad Santokhi, describing it as an irreparable loss not only for Suriname but also for the global Indian diaspora. The condolence highlights the strong personal and diplomatic ties shared between the two leaders.

67. India has emerged as the global leader in issuing Internationally Recognised Certificates of Compliance (IRCCs) under the Nagoya Protocol on Access and Benefit-sharing (ABS). With 3,561 certificates issued out of a global total of 6,311, India accounts for over 56% of all IRCCs, demonstrating its strong commitment to biodiversity governance and equitable resource sharing.

Defence

1. The Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) and the Indian Navy have successfully conducted four in-flight release trials of the indigenous Air Droppable Container (ADC-150). The trials were carried out from the P-8I maritime patrol aircraft off the coast of Goa between 21st February and 1st March 2026.

2. An Indian Armed Forces contingent has arrived in Seychelles to participate in the 11th edition of the joint military exercise "Lamitiye 2026". The exercise is being conducted with the Seychelles Defence Forces (SDF) at the Seychelles Defence Academy from 9th March to 20th March. The initiative reflects the growing defence cooperation between India and Seychelles and aims to strengthen operational coordination between the armed forces of the two countries.

3. India is advancing its unmanned warfare capabilities with the development of the Sheshnaag-150, a long-range swarming attack drone currently undergoing testing. Developed by Bengaluru-based defence startup Newspace Research Technologies, the drone represents India's effort to build cost-effective and flexible unmanned systems similar to those increasingly used in modern conflicts.

4. India is closely monitoring the evolving security situation in parts of West Asia following the recent escalation of regional tensions. The Indian government has placed naval assets deployed under Operation Sankalp on standby to respond to potential humanitarian assistance and disaster relief (HADR) requirements.

5. India has taken a major step towards strengthening its maritime and defence manufacturing capabilities with the foundation of the world's first Autonomous Maritime Shipbuilding and Systems Centre in Andhra Pradesh. The facility is being developed by Mumbai-based Sagar Defence Engineering at the Juvvaladinne fishing harbour in Nellore district, marking a significant milestone in indigenous maritime technology development.

6. The Indian Army participated in the National Additive Manufacturing Symposium 2026 held in New Delhi, joining representatives from government institutions, academia and industry. The event focused on the expanding role of additive manufacturing in strengthening India's manufacturing ecosystem and enhancing strategic defence capabilities.

7. The Indian Navy is participating in Exercise Sea Dragon 2026, a United States-led multinational anti-submarine warfare (ASW) drill being conducted at Andersen Air Force Base in Guam. The exercise, held annually in the Indo-Pacific, gains added significance amid evolving geopolitical tensions, particularly due to the ongoing instability in West Asia.

8. The Indian Navy has commenced the second edition of the Indian Ocean Ship (IOS) SAGAR initiative from 16th March 2026, reinforcing India's commitment to maritime cooperation in the Indian Ocean Region. The initiative follows India's recent assumption of chairmanship of the Indian Ocean Naval Symposium (IONS) and involves participation from 16 member nations, highlighting growing regional engagement.

9. India is considering joining one of Europe's major sixth-generation fighter aircraft programmes-Future Combat Air System (FCAS) or Global Combat Air Programme (GCAP)-as part of its strategy to enhance future air combat capabilities. A Parliamentary panel has recommended evaluating such partnerships to accelerate access to advanced aerospace technologies while complementing domestic defence initiatives.

10. The Indian Army's Southern Command recently conducted Exercise Amogh Jwala at the Babina Field Firing Ranges, highlighting advanced mechanised warfare capabilities. The high-intensity drill demonstrated India's growing military preparedness through integrated, multi-domain operations involving land, air and technological assets.

11. The Indian Navy has initiated Operation Urja Suraksha to safeguard India-bound energy shipments passing through the strategically vital Strait of Hormuz amid escalating tensions in West Asia. The operation is being conducted with precision and limited publicity to ensure uninterrupted and secure transit of Indian-flagged vessels carrying critical energy resources such as LNG, LPG and crude oil.

12. The Indian Army has recently begun inducting Shaurya Squadrons, specialised drone sub-units embedded within armoured regiments. This initiative marks a significant step towards modernising battlefield capabilities by integrating advanced drone technology directly at the unit level, enabling faster and more precise combat operations.

13. The Ministry of Defence has signed two significant contracts worth Rs. 858 crore to strengthen India's military capabilities. The agreements include procurement of the Tunguska Air Defence Missile System for the Indian Army and depot-level inspection of P-8I maritime aircraft for the Indian Navy.

14. The Indian Air Force is set to upgrade its MiG-29UPG fighter jets with the Advanced Short Range Air-to-Air Missile (ASRAAM), significantly strengthening its close-range air combat capability. The move reflects ongoing efforts to modernise existing aircraft fleets with advanced weapon systems to maintain operational readiness in evolving aerial warfare scenarios.

15. India recently hosted a key maritime exercise under the Indian Ocean Naval Symposium (IONS)

at the Maritime Warfare Centre in Kochi. The event brought together naval representatives from multiple countries to address emerging non-traditional maritime security challenges in the Indian Ocean Region (IOR).

16. India recently conducted Exercise Dweep Shakti, a high-intensity Tri-Service drill from 24th to 28th March 2026 aimed at strengthening coastal and island defence capabilities. The Army, Navy and Air Force participated in a coordinated manner, reflecting growing emphasis on joint operations.

17. India has strengthened its maritime defence capabilities with the delivery of Agray, an Anti-Submarine Warfare Shallow Water Craft (ASW SWC), to the Indian Navy. This induction marks another milestone in India's push for indigenous naval shipbuilding and coastal security enhancement. The vessel is part of a broader programme aimed at improving anti-submarine warfare and surveillance in shallow coastal waters.

18. The Indian Navy has received INS Dunagiri, the fifth stealth frigate under the Nilgiri-class (Project 17A), marking a major advancement in indigenous warship construction. The induction strengthens India's maritime capabilities and highlights progress in self-reliant defence manufacturing.

19. India marked a significant milestone in indigenous naval capability with the launch of Yard 1280, named 'Shachi', the first of eleven Next Generation Offshore Patrol Vessels (NGOPVs). The vessel was launched on 31st March 2026 at Goa Shipyard Limited (GSL), Goa, in the presence of senior naval officials and dignitaries.

Business, Economy & Banking

1. In line with the Union Budget 2026-27 announcement by the Union Minister for Finance and Corporate Affairs, the Central Board of Indirect Taxes and Customs (CBIC) has introduced a new facilitation measure for trusted manufacturers. The initiative enables deferred payment of Customs duty for a newly defined category of importers termed Eligible Manufacturer Importers (EMIs). Detailed guidelines have been issued through Circular No. 08/2026-Customs dated 28th February 2026.

2. Atanu Chakraborty has resigned as the part-time chairman and independent director of HDFC Bank with immediate effect, citing ethical concerns. In his resignation letter, he stated that certain practices within the bank over the past two years were not aligned with his personal values. The sudden exit has drawn attention to governance standards at one of India's largest private sector banks.

3. India's semiconductor and electronics industry is facing potential disruption following Iran's reported attack on Qatar's Ras Laffan LNG hub on 19th March. The incident has raised concerns over helium availability, a critical byproduct of liquefied natural gas essential for semiconductor manufacturing. The development comes at a crucial time when India is expanding its ambitions to become a global hub for electronics and chip production.

4. Prime Minister Narendra Modi is set to participate in the upcoming G7 Summit in France from 15th to 17th June, marking India's continued engagement with major global economies. The confirmation came during high-level diplomatic discussions held alongside the G7 Foreign Minister's Meeting.

5. The National Housing Bank (NHB), the apex housing finance institution in India, has launched the Gruh Sugam Portal to simplify and digitise access to home loans for defence personnel, paramilitary forces and government employees. The initiative aims to promote affordable housing, improve financial inclusion and accelerate digital lending adoption, especially for individuals posted in remote and inaccessible locations.

6. The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has unveiled its 'Payments Vision 2028', outlining a comprehensive roadmap to transform India's digital payments ecosystem over the next three years. The vision focuses on enhancing user control, strengthening fraud protection, improving cross-border payment systems, and promoting ease of doing business through 15 targeted initiatives.

7. The Reserve Bank of India has unveiled its Payments Vision 2028 with a strong emphasis on improving user convenience and flexibility in the banking system. A key proposal is to enable bank account portability, allowing customers to switch accounts more easily without disrupting their financial activities. The move reflects RBI's broader goal of enhancing customer empowerment and reducing friction in digital payments.

8. More than 200 global business organisations have jointly urged the extension of the World Trade Organization (WTO) E-commerce Moratorium, as its expiry approaches at the upcoming 14th Ministerial Conference in Yaounde, Cameroon. The issue has once again highlighted divisions between developed and developing countries over digital trade regulations.

Science & Technology

- 1.** In a major scientific breakthrough, researchers have identified a new genus and species of subterranean fish, "Gitchak nakana", from a dug-out well in western Assam. The discovery marks the first aquifer-dwelling, or phreatobitic, fish recorded from Northeast India.
- 2.** Scientists from the Zoological Survey of India (ZSI) have discovered two new species of lichen moths in the eastern Himalayan region, highlighting the rich biodiversity of the area. The newly identified species - "Caulocera hollowayi" and "Asura buxa" - were formally described by Indian researchers and published in the international taxonomic journal "Zootaxa" on 2nd March 2026.
- 3.** New radar evidence from China's Zhurong rover suggests that Mars once hosted beaches similar to those on Earth. Scientists have long suspected the presence of a large ancient ocean on the Red Planet, based on surface images showing dried river channels and valley networks. However, conclusive geological proof remained uncertain.
- 4.** Technology company IBM has launched its first Infrastructure Innovation Centre in India at its India Systems Development Lab (ISDL) campus. Named the Sangam Infrastructure Innovation Centre, the facility aims to strengthen India's role as a hub for advanced infrastructure engineering and artificial intelligence (AI) innovation.
- 5.** The Indian Institute of Science (IISc), Bengaluru, has launched an ambitious "moonshot" project to develop brain co-processors that integrate neuromorphic hardware with artificial intelligence algorithms to enhance or restore brain function. The initiative is supported by the Pratiksha Trust, founded by Infosys co-founder Kris Gopalakrishnan and Sudha Gopalakrishnan.
- 6.** The inaugural Raisina Science Diplomacy Initiative (SDI) was held on 5th March 2026 at Bharat Mandapam in New Delhi as part of the Raisina Dialogue. The initiative was jointly launched by the Office of the Principal Scientific Adviser to the Government of India and the Observer Research Foundation (ORF).
- 7.** India's private space sector is preparing for a major milestone as Hyderabad-based startup Skyroot Aerospace readies the launch of Vikram-1, the country's first privately developed orbital rocket. The mission marks a significant step in India's growing commercial space ecosystem, driven by startups aiming to provide affordable and flexible satellite launch services.
- 8.** Researchers have identified two new freshwater fish species from Nagaland, highlighting the rich but underexplored aquatic biodiversity of Northeast India. The discoveries were published in the international journal "Zootaxa" and were made by J. Praveenraj of the Indian Council of Agricultural Research - Central Island Agricultural Research Institute and independent researcher Balaji Vijayakrishnan.
- 9.** The Thiruvananthapuram Municipal Corporation has introduced an AI-powered robotic system named G-SPIDER for canal cleaning under the Swachh Bharat Mission-Urban 2.0. The robot has been deployed at the Amayizhanchan canal near the Thampanoor railway station to eliminate the need for manual scavenging in hazardous environments.
- 10.** President Droupadi Murmu has announced a major reshuffle in the gubernatorial and lieutenant governor positions across several Indian States and Union Territories. The appointments involve transfers, new postings and acceptance of a resignation, reflecting changes in the administrative leadership of multiple regions.
- 11.** Astronomers have discovered an extremely powerful cosmic "space laser" known as a hydroxyl megamaser in a distant galaxy more than 8 billion light-years from Earth. The discovery was made using the MeerKAT radio telescope in South Africa and represents one of the most distant and energetic examples of such phenomena ever observed.
- 12.** Researchers at the University of Waterloo in Canada have developed an innovative method to convert plastic waste into acetic acid, the main component of vinegar, using only sunlight. The breakthrough offers a promising solution to tackle

plastic pollution while producing a valuable industrial chemical.

13. The Indian Institute of Technology Guwahati (IIT-G) has signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with the Coventry University Group (CUG), United Kingdom, to strengthen global research collaboration in artificial intelligence and healthcare. The agreement aims to promote academic mobility, joint research initiatives and collaborative degree programmes.

14. Entomologists have discovered two previously unknown species of fruit flies and documented an insect group never before recorded in India during a research expedition in the Himalayan foothills. The study was conducted in the Solan region of Himachal Pradesh by Maneesh Pal Singh from the College of Horticulture and Forestry and British researcher David Lawrence Hancock.

15. Scientists have identified a new ancient reptile species that lived in what is now the United States around 225-201 million years ago during the Late Triassic period. The discovery was made by palaeontologists from the University of Washington and the Burke Museum of Natural History and Culture in Seattle.

16. Marine science researchers from Berhampur University have recorded the presence of a rare shrimp-like marine amphipod species in Indian waters for the first time. The discovery was made at Arjyapalli in Odisha's Ganjam district during a field survey of rocky coastal habitats. The species, identified as "Stenothoe lowryi", was previously reported only from Malaysia, and its distribution in other regions had remained largely unknown until now.

17. Arpita Patra, a professor at the Indian Institute of Science (IISc), has successfully summited Nevado Ojos del Salado, the highest volcanic peak in the world and the tallest mountain in Chile. By reaching the summit at an altitude of 6,893 metres on 6th March she became the second Indian woman to achieve this milestone.

18. The European Space Agency's ambitious Proba-3 mission to study the Sun's outer

atmosphere has encountered a major technical setback after losing contact with one of its two spacecraft. The mission aims to capture detailed images of the Sun's corona by creating artificial solar eclipses in space.

19. A recent scientific study has revealed that NASA's Double Asteroid Redirection Test (DART) mission produced a greater impact than initially expected. The experiment not only changed the motion of a small asteroid within its binary system but also slightly altered the entire system's orbit around the Sun.

20. Meta, the parent company of Facebook, has reportedly acquired Moltbook, an experimental social networking platform designed for artificial intelligence agents. The acquisition highlights the intensifying competition among global technology companies to secure advanced AI talent and tools. Moltbook had earlier attracted attention after OpenAI CEO Sam Altman publicly joked about the platform while discussing the future of autonomous AI agents.

21. Scientists searching for ways to sustain human life on Mars are studying one of the most remote places on Earth-Devon Island in Nunavut, Canada. Known as the world's largest uninhabited island, this Arctic landscape provides conditions strikingly similar to those found on Mars.

22. Scientists have discovered a new species of flying reptile after analysing a rare fossilised regurgitate, commonly referred to as dinosaur vomit. The specimen, dated to about 100 million years ago, was recovered from the Romualdo Formation in Brazil's Araripe Basin. Named "Bakiribu waridza", the species represents the first extinct animal to be scientifically described entirely from fossilised regurgitated material.

23. NASA has confirmed that asteroid 2024 YR4 will not collide with the Moon in 2032, resolving earlier concerns about a possible lunar impact. The asteroid, discovered in late 2024, had initially raised alarms when preliminary orbital models suggested a small but measurable chance of collision with the Moon on 22nd December 2032.

24. Scientists have identified evidence of Earth's earliest animals in rocks more than 541 million years old, pushing back the timeline of complex life. The discovery suggests that soft-bodied sea sponges were among the first animals to inhabit the planet's oceans, long before the Cambrian explosion. The findings indicate that some biological traits seen in modern sponges were already present in these ancient organisms.

25. Scientists have discovered a rare parasitic wasp species from a tea estate in Assam, highlighting the largely unexplored biodiversity within plantation ecosystems. The discovery was made during a taxonomic study conducted by researchers from the Zoological Survey of India, the Centre for Biodiversity Genomics at the University of Guelph in Canada, and the Kalinga Foundation.

26. The International Malaria Conference (IMC) 2026 concluded in New Delhi after three days of scientific discussions and global engagement aimed at accelerating malaria elimination efforts. Organised by the ICMR-National Institute of Malaria Research under the Indian Council of Medical Research, the conference was held from 7th to 9th March 2026.

27. A viral outbreak inside Jalpaiguri Central Correctional Home in West Bengal has raised serious public health concerns after 92 inmates were infected with the Herpes Simplex Virus (HSV) between August 2025 and March 2026. Official records indicate that seven inmates died due to complications linked to the infection.

28. Researchers have recently discovered a new species of earthworm named *Drawida vazhania* in Kerala's Peechi-Vazhani Wildlife Sanctuary. The species was identified near the Vazhani Dam area in Thrissur district. The discovery highlights the rich but still underexplored biodiversity of the Western Ghats, a globally recognised biodiversity hotspot.

29. A recent faunal survey conducted by the Zoological Survey of India (ZSI) at the Megamalai Wildlife Sanctuary in Tamil Nadu has led to the discovery of nine species. The findings highlight the ecological richness of the region and reaffirm

the importance of systematic biodiversity assessments in protected areas.

30. Scientists from the Botanical Survey of India (BSI) have rediscovered a rare plant species, *Henckelia monophylla*, in Arunachal Pradesh after nearly 189 years. The species was originally collected in 1836 but had not been recorded again for almost two centuries. The rediscovery highlights the remarkable biodiversity of India's northeastern region and underscores the importance of botanical exploration in remote forest ecosystems.

31. India hosted the BIMSTEC Young Professionals Exchange Programme in Maharashtra from 9th to 15th March 2026 to strengthen regional cooperation and knowledge sharing among emerging leaders of the Bay of Bengal region. The initiative was organised to provide exposure to India's rapidly growing innovation, start-up, research and technology ecosystems.

32. The Council of Scientific and Industrial Research-National Chemical Laboratory (CSIR-NCL) has announced plans to scale up Dimethyl Ether (DME) technology to an industrial-scale demonstration in collaboration with a processing engineering partner. The initiative aims to promote cleaner alternative fuels in India and reduce dependence on conventional diesel.

33. Scientists have identified a new category of exoplanets that exist in a permanent molten, liquid-like state. The discovery, based on observations from the James Webb Space Telescope, challenges traditional classifications of small planets. These worlds are neither rocky nor water-rich but instead consist of vast, global oceans of magma, offering fresh insights into planetary diversity beyond the solar system.

34. Scientists in West Bengal have identified a new species of estuarine fish named "*Butis bargabhimae*", marking a notable addition to India's aquatic biodiversity. The discovery was made in the Rupnarayan River near Tamruk, a region known for its rich ecological and cultural heritage. This finding highlights the importance of

estuarine ecosystems as hotspots of unique and often unexplored species.

35. Researchers have recently uncovered two ancient petroglyphs on a flat rock surface inside a rock shelter near the Beerappa Temple in Manchirevula, Telangana. This discovery adds to India's rich prehistoric heritage and offers valuable insights into early human expression and communication systems.

36. Researchers have recently identified a unique biological phenomenon in a freshwater crab species, "Vela carli", in the forests of Silent Valley National Park, Kerala. The discovery is significant as the species exhibited gynandromorphy, a rare condition where an organism possesses both male and female characteristics, marking a first for this crab family.

37. Researchers at the Indian Institute of Technology Guwahati have developed an advanced material capable of producing hydrogen fuel through water electrolysis while also enabling solar-powered desalination. The innovation addresses two critical global challenges-clean energy generation and access to safe drinking water-through a single, efficient system.

38. Scientists have uncovered a remarkably preserved 289-million-year-old reptile skin fossil in Oklahoma, offering new insights into early life on land. The discovery, made in the Richards Spur cave system, is now considered the oldest known fossilised reptile skin, pushing back the timeline of skin evolution by over 130 million years.

39. India has achieved a technological milestone with the successful testing of an indigenously developed Floating LiDAR Buoy System by the National Institute of Ocean Technology (NIOT). Conducted off the coast of Muttom in Tamil Nadu, the innovation marks a major step forward in ocean observation and atmospheric data collection, especially for offshore environments.

40. Scientists have decoded the evolution of the Ladakh Magmatic Arc (LMA) in the north-western Himalaya, uncovering a geological record spanning nearly 130 million years. This arc provides crucial evidence of the long-term

interaction between the Indian and Eurasian plates, including subduction, magmatic development and eventual continental collision.

41. Researchers at the Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Jodhpur are developing advanced flexible semiconductor sensors aimed at continuous health monitoring and early disease detection. The work is being carried out at the HESTECH (Hybrid Electronic Sensor Technologies) Lab, focusing on wearable devices that can track physiological and biochemical signals in real time.

42. Scientists have uncovered evidence of a vast water reservoir located nearly 700 kilometres beneath the Earth's surface, potentially containing more water than all oceans combined. This "hidden ocean" is not a liquid body but water trapped within minerals deep inside the mantle. The discovery is reshaping scientific understanding of Earth's internal structure and the origin of its water.

43. Researchers from the Zoological Survey of India (ZSI) have identified a new species of cockroach, *Neoloboptera peninsularis*, in the Deccan Peninsula. The discovery, made in Pune district of Maharashtra, marks a significant advancement in entomological research and highlights the biodiversity richness of Peninsular India.

44. Researchers at the Rohini Nilekani Centre for Brain and Mind (CBM), a collaboration between NIMHANS and NCBS-TIFR, have developed CALM-Brain, a pioneering digital repository focused on neuropsychiatric disorders. This initiative represents a major step forward in India's mental health research ecosystem by integrating diverse datasets for advanced scientific analysis.

45. NASA has launched a Rs. 283.8 crore (\$30 million) mission to prevent its ageing Neil Gehrels Swift Observatory from falling out of orbit and potentially crashing towards Earth. The observatory, operational since 2004, is gradually losing altitude due to increased atmospheric drag, prompting an innovative rescue effort to extend its lifespan.

46. Researchers in India have demonstrated the use of artificial intelligence to monitor nest site fidelity in painted storks at the National Zoological Park, Delhi. The study focused on a single male stork, informally named "Ringo", tracked over four breeding seasons from 2022 to 2025. The work highlights how non-invasive digital tools can advance behavioural ecology studies without disturbing wildlife.

47. A new scientific study has revealed that metformin, one of the most widely used drugs for type 2 diabetes, acts directly on the brain to regulate blood sugar levels. The findings, published in "Science Advances" by researchers at Baylor College of Medicine, offer a significant shift in understanding how the drug works after more than six decades of clinical use.

48. A new digital platform, MLATrack.com, has been launched to provide comprehensive insights into the legislative activities of Members of the Kerala Legislative Assembly. Developed by Atyeti Research in collaboration with Sahya Digital Conservation Foundation, the portal covers the period from 2021 to 2026 and aims to enhance transparency and public engagement in legislative processes.

49. The Institute of Indian Foundrymen (IIF) and CSIR-Central Road Research Institute (CSIR-CRRI) have recently entered into an agreement to promote the utilisation of waste foundry sand in road construction. The initiative aims to address environmental challenges associated with industrial waste while supporting sustainable infrastructure development in India.

50. A new butterfly species, *Euthalia zubeengargi*, has recently been recorded in Arunachal Pradesh, adding to the rich biodiversity of India's northeastern region. The discovery highlights the ecological significance of the region, which is known for its unique flora and fauna and remains a hotspot for new species identification.

51. NASA has recently developed a detailed map of the ocean floor using data from the Surface Water and Ocean Topography (SWOT) satellite. This advancement marks a significant step in understanding underwater features and global

water dynamics, contributing to climate studies and oceanographic research.

52. The western region of Rajasthan has recently been identified as a key wintering stronghold for the Steppe Eagle, a large migratory raptor. This recognition highlights the ecological importance of India's arid landscapes in supporting globally threatened species during their migratory cycle.

53. Scientists from the Wildlife Institute of India (WII), Dehradun have recently documented two rare keelback snake species in Northeast India. The Rakhine Keelback ("*Herpetoreas davidi*") was recorded in Ngengpui Wildlife Sanctuary, while the Kachin Hills Keelback ("*Hebius gilhodesi*") was identified in Namdapha National Park and Kamlang Tiger Reserve, highlighting the region's rich biodiversity.

54. The Government of India has invited nominations for the Rashtriya Vigyan Puraskar (RVP) 2026, a major national initiative to recognise excellence in science, technology and innovation. The award aims to honour individuals and teams whose work has significantly contributed to India's scientific advancement and socio-economic development.

55. A new frog species named "*Nyctibatrachus kali*", commonly called the Kali Night Frog, has recently been discovered in Karnataka. The finding highlights the rich biodiversity of the Western Ghats and underscores the importance of continued ecological research in protected areas.

56. India's biotechnology sector marked a key institutional milestone with the inaugural meeting of the Biotechnology Research and Innovation Council-Research Advisory Board (BRIC-RAB) held on 27th - 28th March 2026 at the Regional Centre for Biotechnology, Faridabad.

57. The United States space agency, NASA, is preparing for the Artemis II mission, a significant step in its long-term plan to establish a sustained human presence on the Moon. The mission, expected to launch soon, will carry four astronauts around the Moon, marking humanity's return to lunar vicinity after more than 50 years since the Apollo era.

58. NASA has released new radar imagery captured by the NASA-ISRO Synthetic Aperture Radar (NISAR) satellite, showcasing its advanced capability to observe Earth through dense cloud cover. The images focus on regions in North America, including Seattle, Portland, and Mount St. Helens, areas frequently obscured by clouds.

59. In a major push towards sustainable infrastructure, the Council of Scientific and Industrial Research (CSIR) has transferred an indigenous bio-bitumen technology for large-scale industry adoption. The innovation converts agricultural residue into eco-friendly road construction material, addressing both environmental pollution and resource dependency challenges in India.

60. Recent scientific findings have revealed that extracellular RNA (exRNA) from bacteria can persist even after standard disinfection of drinking water. This discovery has important implications for understanding microbial activity in treated water systems and raises questions about current purification methods.

61. The European Space Agency (ESA) has marked a significant advancement in satellite navigation with the successful launch of the first two satellites of the Celeste in-orbit demonstration mission. The satellites were launched aboard Rocket Lab's Electron rocket from New Zealand, signalling Europe's push to enhance the resilience and capability of its navigation systems.

62. NASA has begun the final countdown for Artemis II, its first crewed mission to the Moon in

over five decades. Scheduled for launch on 1st April 2026, the mission represents a major milestone in human space exploration since the Apollo era. Four astronauts will embark on a nearly 10-day journey, testing systems crucial for future lunar landings under NASA's broader Artemis programme.

63. NASA has announced that its Artemis II mission, the first crewed mission to fly around the Moon in more than five decades, is on track for launch as early as 1st April 2026. The mission will mark a major milestone in human space exploration, as astronauts will once again travel beyond low-Earth orbit.

64. The Department of Pharmaceuticals, under the Ministry of Chemicals and Fertilizers, Government of India, will host the 9th edition of India Pharma 2026 on 13th - 14th April in New Delhi. Organised in collaboration with the Federation of Indian Chambers of Commerce and Industry (FICCI) and the Indian Pharmaceutical Alliance (IPA), the event aims to strengthen India's position as a global leader in pharmaceuticals and life sciences.

65. Andhra Pradesh is set to achieve a major technological milestone with the launch of India's first quantum computer on 14th April 2026, in Amaravati. Chief Minister N. Chandrababu Naidu announced the initiative as part of the State's broader vision to establish itself as a global hub for advanced technologies. The move aligns with India's National Quantum Mission and signals a strong push towards innovation-driven economic growth.

Government Schemes

1. The Meghalaya government has issued a public health advisory following the deaths of two Agniveer trainees from suspected meningococcal bacterial infection at the Assam Regimental Centre (ARC) in Shillong. Over 30 trainees are currently under medical observation, with close contacts quarantined as a precautionary measure. Authorities have stated that no new suspected cases have been detected and the situation remains under control.

2. The Government of Gujarat has launched an intensive vaccination campaign to control the spread of Foot and Mouth Disease (FMD) across the state. The drive began on 1st March 2026 and will continue until 15th April under the National Animal Disease Control Programme (NADCP).

3. The Karnataka government has proposed a ban on social media use for children under the age of 16 as part of its 2026-27 state budget. Chief minister Siddaramaiah announced the move while presenting his 17th budget in the state assembly, stating that the measure aims to reduce the harmful effects of excessive mobile phone use among minors.

4. Tamil Nadu Chief Minister M. K. Stalin has launched the Tamil Nadu Women Entrepreneur Empowerment Scheme (TWEES) to promote women-led businesses in the State. The initiative, designed by the Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSME) Department, aims to encourage one lakh women to take up entrepreneurship over the next five years.

5. The Union government has launched a nationwide social media campaign to address the practice of "Sarpanch Pati", where male relatives exercise authority in place of elected women leaders in village governance. Announced by the Ministry of Panchayati Raj (MoPR), the campaign titled "Say No To Proxy Sarpanch" aims to empower women sarpanches and strengthen democratic participation in grassroots governance.

6. The National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development (NABARD), in collaboration with the Gates Foundation and Dalberg Advisors, has

launched the National Climate Stack Innovation Challenge to strengthen India's climate resilience framework for rural regions. The initiative aims to build foundational technological layers of a National Climate Stack that will integrate diverse climate datasets and enable more effective climate intelligence for agriculture, rural finance, and public planning.

7. Union Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal inaugurated the 40th edition of the AAHAR International Food and Hospitality Fair in New Delhi. The event is being organised jointly by the Ministry of Food Processing Industries (MoFPI) and the India Trade Promotion Organisation (ITPO) from 10th to 14th March 2026.

8. Gujarat is strengthening its efforts toward sustainable urban development with the launch of the 'Lake and Air Watch' initiative under the Gujarat Urban Development Mission (GUDM). The programme aims to monitor lake health and air quality in real time across cities. The initiative supports the broader vision of building environmentally resilient and future-ready cities as part of India's 'Viksit Bharat' mission.

9. The Government of India is implementing the World's Largest Grain Storage Plan in the Cooperative Sector to strengthen rural storage infrastructure and improve foodgrain management. The initiative focuses on developing modern storage facilities at the level of Primary Agricultural Credit Societies (PACS) and other cooperative institutions.

10. The Chhattisgarh government has approved the draft of a new anti-religious conversion law titled the "Chhattisgarh Freedom of Religion Bill, 2026". The proposal aims to prevent religious conversions carried out through force, inducement, fraud, misrepresentation, or undue influence.

11. The Goa government has decided to introduce the Goa Advocate Protection Bill 2026 in the state legislative assembly to address rising incidents of violence, intimidation, and harassment against advocates. The proposed legislation aims to provide legal safeguards for lawyers while

ensuring accountability through checks against misuse.

12. Prime Minister Narendra Modi launched infrastructure projects worth Rs. 23,550 crore in Silchar, Assam, aimed at transforming the Barak Valley into a major trade and logistics gateway in Northeast India. Addressing a public gathering in Ramnagar near Silchar, the Prime Minister emphasised that improved connectivity would strengthen the region's integration with national and international markets, particularly in Bangladesh, Myanmar and other South Asian.

13. Gujarat Chief Minister Bhupendra Patel launched the fifth edition of the herSTART programme for women entrepreneurs at Gujarat University in Ahmedabad. The event also marked the inauguration of a new research park aimed at strengthening the state's innovation ecosystem.

14. The Uttarakhand government has introduced comprehensive healthcare arrangements for the upcoming Char Dham Yatra to ensure the safety and well-being of pilgrims. A key initiative is the 'e-Swasthya Dham' portal, which will enable real-time monitoring of pilgrims health and facilitate immediate medical assistance when required.

15. The Prime Minister recently virtually inaugurated the 120 MW Lower Kopili Hydroelectric Project in Assam. The project is an important step towards strengthening clean energy infrastructure in Northeast India and enhancing regional power generation capacity. It also supports India's broader goals of expanding renewable energy and improving electricity availability in remote and hilly regions.

16. The Department of Posts, under the Ministry of Communications, has introduced a new premium service called "24 Speed Post" to ensure faster and reliable delivery of urgent consignments. The initiative aims to enhance logistics efficiency and cater to growing demand from businesses and individuals for time-bound delivery services.

17. India has launched an anti-dumping investigation into imports of ethyl chloroformate from China following allegations by domestic manufacturer Paushak Ltd that the chemical is

being sold at unfairly low prices. The Directorate General of Trade Remedies (DGTR), under the Ministry of Commerce and Industry, has initiated the probe to assess whether such imports have caused material injury to the domestic industry.

18. The Ministry of Ayush has launched "Yoga 365", a nationwide initiative aimed at encouraging daily adoption of yoga as part of routine life. The campaign was unveiled during Yoga Mahotsav-2026 at Vigyan Bhawan, New Delhi, marking the 100-day countdown to the International Day of Yoga (IDY) 2026.

19. The Government of India has notified amendments to the National Highways Fee Rules, 2026 to enhance toll compliance and improve transparency in toll collection systems. The National Highways Fee (Determination of Rates and Collection) (Second Amendment) Rules, 2026 introduce a structured and technology-driven framework to address unpaid user fees and streamline enforcement across National Highways.

20. The Telangana government has initiated the rehabilitation and relocation of tribal families residing within the Amrabad Tiger Reserve as part of a broader strategy to balance wildlife conservation with socio-economic development. The move seeks to reduce human-wildlife conflict while ensuring improved living standards and livelihood opportunities for indigenous communities.

21. The Rajasthan government has unveiled the Industrial Park Promotion Policy-2026 to accelerate industrial growth, attract investments and generate employment opportunities across the state. Spearheaded under the leadership of Chief Minister Bhajanlal Sharma, the policy aims to transform Rajasthan into a future-ready and globally competitive industrial destination through the development of modern infrastructure and business-friendly reforms.

22. The Ministry of Railways is implementing the Amrit Bharat Station Scheme to modernise railway infrastructure across India with a long-term, phased approach. A total of 1338 stations have been identified for redevelopment, including 13 key stations in Delhi. The initiative aims to enhance

passenger amenities, improve connectivity and transform stations into integrated urban hubs.

23. The Government has introduced the Jan Vishwas (Amendment of Provisions) Bill, 2026 in the Lok Sabha to strengthen trust-based governance and simplify India's regulatory framework. The Bill aims to reduce criminal liability for minor offences and promote ease of doing business and living.

24. The government has introduced changes under the Jan Vishwas Bill to remove imprisonment for several minor offences related to exports in textiles, handlooms and agricultural products. The move aims to promote ease of doing business by replacing criminal penalties with financial penalties and warnings.

25. The Union government is considering a major policy shift to extend social security coverage to unorganised sector workers by bringing them under the Employee's Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO) and the Employee's State Insurance Corporation (ESIC). The proposal aims to ensure pension and insurance benefits for millions of workers currently outside formal welfare systems, including gig and platform workers.

26. The Central Government has allocated Rs. 3,880 crore to Nagaland under the "Pride of Hills: Special Development Assistance for the Hill States" scheme for the financial year 2026-27. The initiative is designed to address structural challenges faced by hill states, including difficult terrain, limited connectivity, sparse populations and constrained revenue bases.

27. The Union Cabinet has approved the continuation of the Immigration, Visa, Foreigners Registration and Tracking (IVFRT) Scheme for a five-year period from 1st April 2026 to 31st March 2031. The move aims to strengthen India's immigration framework through advanced digital integration and improved service delivery.

28. The Government of India has extended subsidies under the PM E-DRIVE scheme to promote electric mobility, with incentives for electric two-wheelers continuing until 31st July 2026 and for electric rickshaws and carts until 31st March 2028. The move reflects a sustained policy push to accelerate the transition towards cleaner transportation and reduce dependence on fossil fuels.

Awards & Honours

1. Late Hollywood actor Catherine O'Hara was honoured with a standing ovation at the SAG-AFTRA Screen Actors Guild Awards after winning Outstanding Performance by a Female Actor in a Comedy Series for her role in "The Studio". The award was presented posthumously following her passing in January at the age of 71.

2. A 60-year-old woman from Assam's Cachar district has become the first person in the state to receive Indian citizenship under the Citizenship Amendment Act (CAA). Dipali Das, a resident of Hawaithang in the Dholai block, received her citizenship certificate on 6th March, ending years of uncertainty over her legal status in India.

3. Veteran Telugu actor Chiranjeevi has been honoured with the prestigious NTR National Film

Award at the Gaddar Telangana Film Awards 2025. Expressing gratitude for the honour, the megastar described receiving an award associated with legendary actor and leader N. T. Rama Rao as a deeply emotional and meaningful moment in his career.

4. Renowned Tamil poet, lyricist and writer R. Vairamuthu has been selected for the 60th Jnanpith Award for the year 2025, India's highest literary recognition. The announcement was made by Bharatiya Jnanpith in March 2026. The award honours his outstanding contribution to Tamil literature, marked by emotional depth, cultural richness and a distinctive poetic voice developed over several decades.

5. Actor Rashmika Mandanna has received the Best Actress award for her performance in the romantic drama "The Girlfriend" at the Gaddar Telangana Film Awards 2025. The recognition highlights her growing prominence in Indian cinema and celebrates her impactful portrayal in the film.

6. Lance Havildar K. G. George (retd), a decorated hero of the 1965 India-Pakistan War and recipient of the Vir Chakra, passed away at the age of 95 in Kerala. George was widely respected for his courage and dedication during wartime service in the Indian Army, particularly for his role in maintaining vital communication lines during intense enemy attacks.

7. Shah Rukh Khan has entered the Hurun Global Rich List 2026 with an estimated net worth of \$1.3 billion, marking a significant milestone in the actor's global financial standing. The list, released on 5th March, ranks the world's US dollar billionaires with wealth calculations recorded up to 15th January 2026.

8. Renowned Indian astrophysicist Yashwant Gupta was honoured with the prestigious MP Birla Memorial Award at the MP Birla Planetarium in Kolkata. Gupta, who serves as the Director of the National Centre for Radio Astrophysics (NCRA) at the Tata Institute of Fundamental Research (TIFR) in Pune, received the recognition for his contributions to radio astronomy and astrophysics.

9. R. M. Nachammai has created history by becoming the first woman to head the operations of a functional nuclear power plant in India under the Nuclear Power Corporation of India Limited (NPCIL). She has been appointed Chief Superintendent of Kaiga Generating Station Units 3 and 4 in Karnataka, with the role taking effect from 15th March 2026.

10. The announcement of a Padma Shri for tribal artist Krishnan Raghavan, known by his pen name 'Kitna', has drawn national attention to the fragile legacy of Kurumba painting in the Nilgiris. Krishnan, who belonged to the Alu Kurumba tribal community, received the honour posthumously earlier this year.

11. Veteran actor, director and theatre practitioner Amol Palekar will be honoured with the Lifetime Achievement Award at the 21st Mahindra Excellence in Theatre Awards (META) 2026. The prestigious theatre festival will be held in New Delhi from 19th to 25th March 2026.

12. The 98th Academy Awards are underway at the Dolby Theatre in Los Angeles, marking the culmination of Hollywood's awards season. Hosted by Conan O'Brien for the second consecutive year, the ceremony features strong competition across major categories. India's presence is marked by actor Priyanka Chopra Jonas appearing as a presenter.

13. Hollywood actress Jessie Buckley won the Best Actress award at the 98th Academy Awards for her performance in the film Hamnet. The victory marked her first Oscar win in a leading category and highlighted her rising stature in international cinema.

14. Indian animation received global recognition after the animated short film CHYIMI won the Best Director Award at the New York Short Animation Festival (NYSAF) 2026. The film is directed by Dr. Partha Sarathi Mahanta, who currently serves as Inspector General of Police (IGP) in Assam and Commissioner of Police, Guwahati.

15. The animated film "KPop Demon Hunters" won the Academy Award for Best Animated Feature at the 98th Academy Awards, marking one of the major highlights of the ceremony held at the Dolby Theatre in Los Angeles. The film, released by Netflix, triumphed over a strong lineup that included "Arco", "Elio", "The Character of Rain", and "Zootopia 2".

16. Indian-origin filmmaker Alexandre Singh won the Oscar for Best Live-Action Short Film at the 98th Academy Awards for the French-language drama Two People Exchanging Saliva. The award was shared in a rare tie with the film The Singers, directed by Sam A. Davis and Jack Piatt.

17. German strongwoman Sina Ruppenthal has gained global attention after setting a remarkable Guinness World Record by lifting and throwing 10 men in just 37.44 seconds. The feat, performed

during a television programme in Munich in August 2025, has recently gone viral, drawing widespread admiration for both her physical prowess and technical precision.

18. Historian William Dalrymple has been awarded the prestigious Mark Lynton History Prize 2026 for his book "The Golden Road: How Ancient India Transformed the World". The award recognises outstanding historical writing that combines scholarly depth with literary excellence.

19. Kaveh Madani, director of the United Nations University Institute for Water, Environment and Health (UNU-INWEH), has been awarded the 2026 Stockholm Water Prize, one of the most prestigious global honours in water research. The announcement was made on 18th March 2026 at UNESCO headquarters in Paris, ahead of World Water Day, with the award to be presented in August during World Water Week in Stockholm.

20. The Indian Institute of Management Kozhikode (IIM-K) has achieved a significant global milestone by entering the top 100 in the QS World University Rankings by Subject 2026 for the first time. This reflects India's growing academic reputation and strengthening presence in global higher education rankings, particularly in management and technical disciplines.

21. Veteran Telugu actor Nandamuri Balakrishna was honoured with the Lifetime Achievement Award at the International Film Festival of Delhi (IFFD) 2026. The recognition marks his remarkable contribution to Indian cinema spanning five decades. The award ceremony, held at Bharat Mandapam in New Delhi, celebrated his enduring legacy and influence in the film industry.

22. Ravichandran Purushothaman, President of Danfoss India, has been elected Chairman of the Confederation of Indian Industry (CII) Southern Region for 2026-27. Krishna Bodanapu, Executive Vice Chairman and Managing Director of Cyient Ltd, will serve as Deputy Chairman. The new

leadership assumes charge at a time when southern India continues to play a vital role in India's industrial and technological growth.

23. India's higher education system has recorded notable progress in the QS World University Rankings by Subject 2026, with increased global representation and improved performance. A total of 99 Indian institutions featured this year, contributing 599 entries across 55 subjects.

24. Nisha Mehta, an alumna of the All India Institute of Medical Sciences (AIIMS), New Delhi, has been appointed as Nepal's Minister for Health and Population. Her elevation marks a rare transition of a nursing professional into a top political and policy-making role in the country's healthcare system. She took oath on 27th March, following a major political shift in Nepal after recent elections.

25. India's largest airline, IndiGo, has appointed aviation veteran Willie Walsh as its new Chief Executive Officer, marking a significant leadership shift aimed at strengthening global expansion and operational stability. The announcement comes amid recent operational disruptions and reflects the airline's ambition to position itself as a major international player in the aviation sector.

26. Mumbai has witnessed a historic administrative milestone with the appointment of senior IAS officer Ashwini Bhide as the commissioner of the Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation (BMC). She becomes the first woman to head India's richest civic body, marking a significant shift in urban governance leadership.

27. Sahitya Akademi announced the Sahitya Akademi Awards 2025 for outstanding literary works in 24 Indian languages recognised by the institution. The awards cover multiple literary genres including poetry, novels, short stories, essays, memoirs, literary criticism, and autobiography. The 2025 award ceremony will be held on 31st March 2026 in New Delhi.

Sport

1. Jammu & Kashmir scripted history by winning their maiden Ranji Trophy title, defeating eight-time champion Karnataka at the KSCA Rajnagar Stadium. On the fifth day, the visitors asserted complete dominance, sealing the championship in emphatic fashion and marking a transformative moment in Indian domestic cricket.

2. Indian cricket star Smriti Mandhana has achieved a unique milestone after becoming the first cricketer to receive her own Barbie doll. The announcement came ahead of International Women's Day 2026 and has drawn attention from both the sports and pop-culture worlds.

3. India's Lakshya Sen delivered a determined performance to enter the final of the All England Open Badminton Championships, marking his second appearance in the prestigious tournament's title clash. The 24-year-old shuttler defeated Canada's Victor Lai in a tough semifinal encounter, reinforcing his status among the world's leading badminton players.

4. Sabrina Wittmann has made history in German football as the first woman to manage a professional men's football team in the country. The 34-year-old coach recently extended her contract with FC Ingolstadt 04, reinforcing the club's trust in her leadership. Her appointment, first made in 2024, marked a landmark moment for gender representation in professional football and has since attracted global attention.

5. India secured a historic triumph in the ICC Men's T20 World Cup 2026 after defeating New Zealand by a massive 96-run margin at the Narendra Modi Stadium in Ahmedabad. The victory marked India's third T20 World Cup title and made it the first team to successfully defend the championship.

6. India and New Zealand have initiated discussions to expand bilateral sports cooperation as 2026 marks 100 years of sporting relations between the two countries. Union Minister for Youth Affairs and Sports Mansukh Mandaviya chaired a high-level ministerial meeting in New Delhi with a New Zealand sports delegation to

explore new avenues of collaboration in sports development, training and innovation.

7. Gujarat Titans have appointed former India wicketkeeper-batter Vijay Dahiya as assistant coach ahead of the upcoming Indian Premier League (IPL) 2026 season. Dahiya brings extensive experience from both international cricket and domestic coaching circuits, adding depth to the Titans support structure.

8. Reigning world champion Shailesh Kumar began his 2026 athletics season on a strong note by winning a gold medal in the men's high jump T63 category at the World Para Athletics Grand Prix in New Delhi. The Indian para athlete registered a best jump of 1.84 metres in the event, marking a successful return to competition after recovering from a knee injury following the World Para Athletics Championships.

9. India concluded its campaign at the World Boxing Futures Cup 2026 in Bangkok with a strong medal haul of five medals, including one gold, three silver and one bronze. The tournament, held from 8th to 15th March, brought together emerging boxers competing in Youth Olympic weight categories.

10. The Board of Control for Cricket in India (BCCI) celebrated the achievements of India's World Cup-winning teams at the Naman Awards 2026 held in New Delhi. The ceremony recognised the success of Indian teams across multiple formats and age groups in recent international tournaments.

11. India finished at the top of the medal standings at the World Para Athletics Grand Prix 2026 New Delhi leg, winning a total of 208 medals as the three-day competition concluded at the Jawaharlal Nehru Stadium. The host nation secured 75 gold, 69 silver and 64 bronze medals, showcasing strong performances across multiple track and field events.

12. Kalinga Stadium in Bhubaneswar is set to host the National Para Athletics Championship from 19th to 21st March 2026, bringing together top para-athletes from across India. The event, organised by

the Paralympic Committee of India (PCI) in collaboration with the Odisha government, highlights the growing prominence of para sports and aims to promote inclusivity and excellence in athletics.

13. India has been awarded the hosting rights for the World Indoor Athletics Championships 2028, marking the country's first time hosting the prestigious global indoor track and field event. The championship will be held at the state-of-the-art indoor facility at the Kalinga Stadium complex in Bhubaneswar, Odisha, reflecting India's growing prominence in international athletics.

14. International Olympic Committee announced on that the transgender women and DSD (Differences of Sex Development) athletes are no longer to be allowed to compete in female categories at the Olympics. The rule will apply to Los Angeles Olympics for year 2028. The decision is aimed at ensuring fairness in competition and also introduced mandatory SRY gene screening for athletes who want to participate in women's events.

15. Italy's Jannik Sinner secured a landmark victory at the Miami Open 2026, defeating Jiri Lehecka 6-4, 6-4 in the final. With this triumph, Sinner completed the prestigious 'Sunshine Double', winning both Indian Wells and Miami in the same season. The achievement places him among an elite group of tennis players and highlights his growing dominance on the ATP Tour.

16. The inaugural edition of the Khelo India Tribal Games (KITG) will be held from 25th March to 6th April in Chhattisgarh. The sporting event will take place across three cities - Raipur, Jagdalpur and Sarguja - and aims to promote sporting talent among tribal communities across India. The announcement was made by Union Minister for Youth Affairs and Sports Mansukh Mandaviya.

17. The Indian Premier League (IPL) 2026 is the 19th season of this league, featuring top players from around the globe. Fans eagerly wait every year to enjoy fast-paced T20 matches, thrilling finishes, and strong team rivalries across different cities in India. IPL 2026 will begin on 28th March and continue until 31st May 2026. The first match of IPL 2026 will be played between: Royal Challengers Bengaluru vs Sunrisers Hyderabad.

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